

Brain-Based Mental Health Community

Trauma-Focused CBT (TF-CBT) Feedback

NAME

DATE

Review the live website before providing feedback:

<https://tcfasd.github.io/Brain-Based-Mental-Health-/handout-therapy-guide.html>

Ages 3–18 | Brain-Based Fit: Moderate With Adaptation

What It Asks the Brain to Do:

TF-CBT is a structured treatment specifically for children who have experienced trauma. It guides the brain through gradual trauma processing using the PRACTICE components: Psychoeducation, Relaxation, Affective modulation, Cognitive coping, Trauma narrative, In-vivo mastery, Conjoint sessions, and Enhancing safety. The child's brain gradually approaches and processes traumatic material in a safe, structured way — rather than avoiding it. It combines cognitive skills with body-based techniques like relaxation.

Caregiver Involvement:

Very high — built into the model. Sessions are typically 90 minutes: 45 minutes with the child, 45 minutes with the caregiver. Caregivers receive all components in parallel and participate in conjoint sessions where the child shares their trauma narrative. This is a major strength.

How to Know If It Might Be a Good Fit:

- Your child has experienced trauma and is showing symptoms (nightmares, avoidance, hypervigilance, emotional dysregulation)
- You want to be actively involved in your child's trauma treatment
- Your child can engage with some level of verbal/cognitive processing (even if simplified)
- The therapist is trained in both TF-CBT and neurodevelopmental adaptations

Brain-Based Consideration

TF-CBT has the same cognitive demands as CBT plus the added requirement of creating a trauma narrative. However, the strong caregiver involvement and structured approach are significant strengths. For children with brain-based differences who carry trauma, a clinician experienced with both TF-CBT and neurodevelopmental differences should assess whether the child can engage with the cognitive and narrative components — and adapt accordingly.

1. Is what is written accurate?

Yes

No

Yes

2. Is there additional information that you think caregivers should know about Trauma-Focused CBT (TF-CBT)?

Thank you for your feedback!